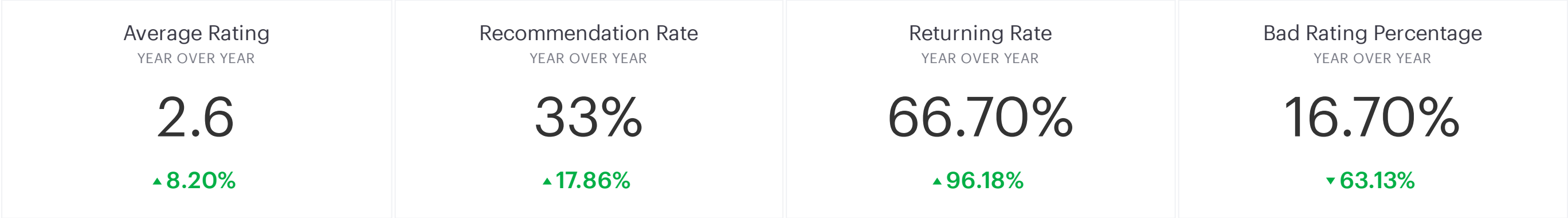


Customer Experience Intelligence — Delta Air Lines

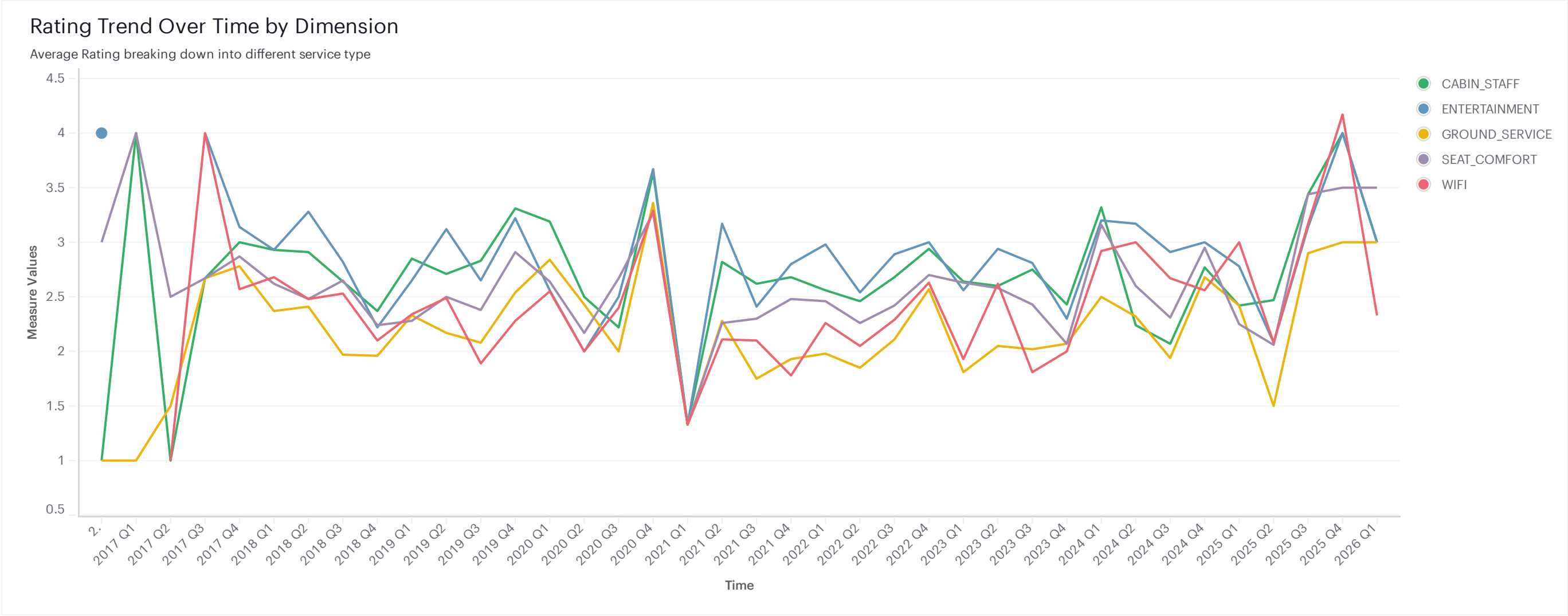
Last updated: April 12nd, 2026
Author: Gina Nguyen
Source: AirlineQuality.com · Verified Reviews · 2017–Q1 2026

At a Glance — How Are We Doing?



Takeaway: All four KPIs moved in the right direction. Improving but from a low base. The loyalty trap — retained but not delighted — is the core tension to resolve.

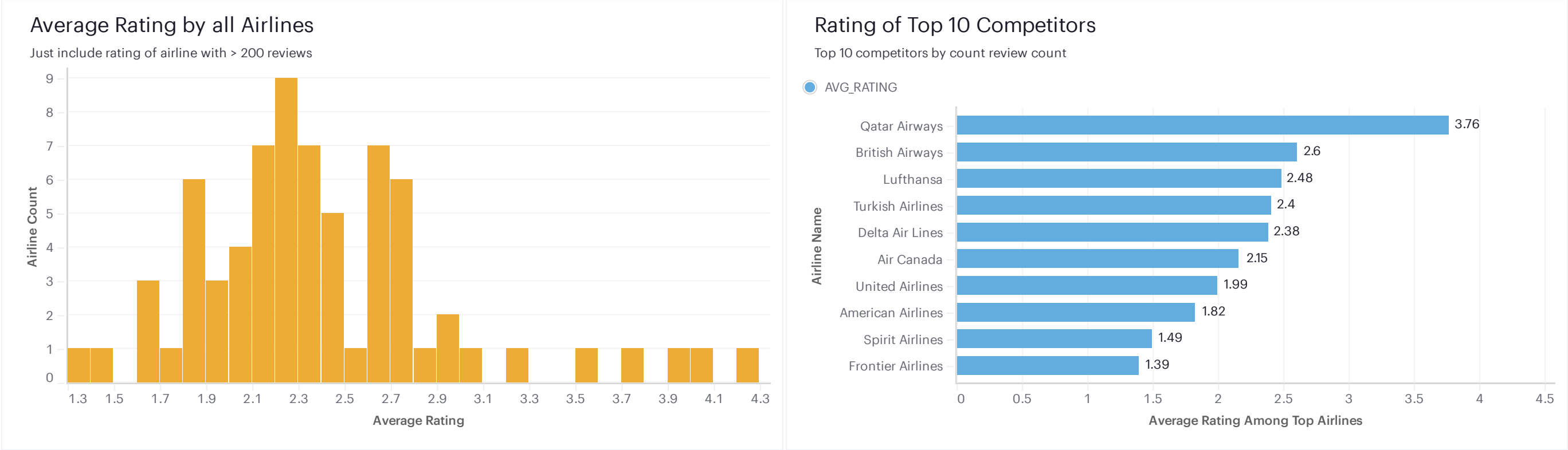
Recommendation: Set Recommendation Rate > 40% as the 12-month north star metric. It is the single most correlated indicator of organic growth.



Takeaway: Cabin Staff — consistently the highest dimension across all 9 years. WiFi — consistently the lowest. Ground Service — most volatile, frequently hits the floor. 2020–2021 — COVID distortion, exclude from baselines. 2025 upswing — visible across all dimensions, aligns with KPI improvements.

Recommendation: WiFi requires capital investment, not process fixes. 9 years of data is the business case. Protect Cabin Staff quality — it is the only thing consistently working.

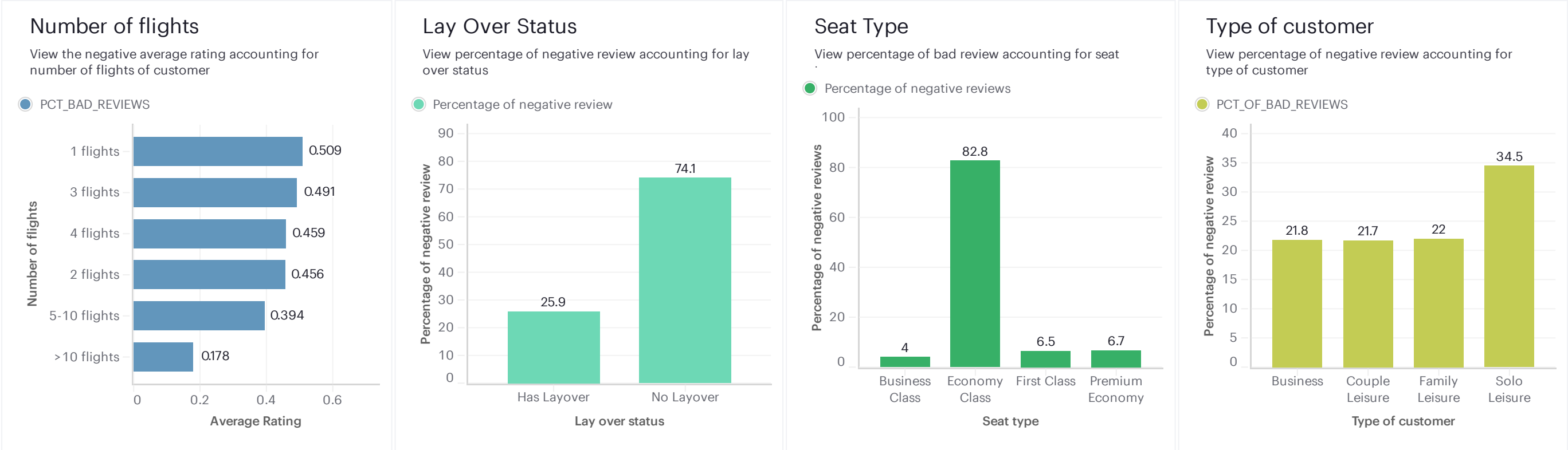
How Do We Stack Up Against Competitors?



Takeaway: Delta leads all US domestic carriers. Delta ranks #5 of 10 among most-reviewed airlines globally while Qatar Airways leads at 3.76. Nearest rivals: Turkish Airlines (2.40), Lufthansa (2.48) — less than 0.10 pts gap.

Recommendation: The realistic 12-month target is Lufthansa (2.48), not Qatar. Monitor United (1.99) closely — a 0.39-point gap is not a safe buffer.

What's Driving Negative Experiences?



Flyer Frequency — Bad review rate drops from 0.509 (1 flight) to 0.178 (10+ flights).First-time passengers are 3x more likely to leave a bad review. First impressions are failing. Loyal customers are more forgiving

Layover Status — 74.1% of bad reviews come from one-time passengers. The in-flight experience is the problem, not connections or hubs.

Seat Type — Economy accounts for 82.8% of bad reviews. Business Class only 4%. Premium product is working. Economy is where the crisis lives.

Traveller Type — Solo Leisure leads at 34.5%, others cluster at 21–22%. Solo Leisure passengers have the highest WiFi and entertainment expectations — Delta's two weakest dimensions.

All four risk factors point to the same passenger: **first-time Solo Leisure Economy traveller on a direct flight expecting good WiFi**. This is not four problems — it is one profile.